



Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Update on plans

6 messages

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>

Mon, Aug 5, 2019 at 4:00 AM

To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>, Walter DeMelle <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Hi both

I hope I have answered your questions OK, Walter - do let me know if you have any more.

I will be going to the archives tomorrow (Tuesday) and will re-examine the paylists, and photograph the column headings.

I've identified some Halifax Prisoner of War registers held at the archives, some of which have been digitised on www.findmypast.co.uk. I've had a search on here for Levi/Leven, to no avail - I also searched for some of the other people noted as 'vol from pris of war' in the playlist and they're not there either, which makes me suspect they're on a different register. My slight qualm is that the registers seem to be in a somewhat random order - if they're by date of discharge that will be fine (ie I'll look around (16 dec 1813) otherwise it might be like looking for a needle in a haystack, but I'll know more when I get them.

Meanwhile, Walter - as keeper of the flame for the DeMelle genealogy, can I ask what other information you might have about Levi? Do you have any marriage details for him? I assume so, if he has been identified as your 3 x great grandfather. If so, do you know when and where he married, and what religion he might have been?

What led you to know that he was in the KGL? Was it the land grant which mentions Levi DeMill? I note that land was granted to men who had fought in Europe, which Leven Demell clearly had not if he was recruited as PoW. Just to be sure, I'll double-check the list of names in the 60th to confirm there are no other possibilities for our man.

I'll get back to you either tomorrow evening or on Wednesday.

Best regards
Ruth

wdemelle . <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Mon, Aug 5, 2019 at 3:21 PM

To: Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>

Cc: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Dear Ruth and Todd,

I have spent considerable time on this and don't have a lot more clarity. However, I have put together some notes which are taken from my (not great) files. They are attached to this email. I hope this helps some. I apologize for my lack of precision and poor memory on these matters. Most of my work on this took place 12-15 years ago. Some of my knowledge was gleaned from relatives whom I met when I went to Nova Scotia and spoke extensively with them. One in particular, now deceased, had done a great deal of work on family history as it relates to records in the local Anglican church. Unfortunately I did not do a good job of documenting this material.

So...please see attached. I hope there is some help there.

Walter
Lakeville, CT
5 August 2019
[Quoted text hidden]

2 attachments



Notes- Marriage info Levi Dimmell.docx

16K



Some notes on Land Grants.docx

15K

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: "wdemelle ." <wdemelle@gmail.com>
Cc: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Mon, Aug 5, 2019 at 4:06 PM

Dear Walter

Thank you for taking the trouble to summarise your notes - very helpful. I'm pleased to see that Levi's name has been recorded as Leven elsewhere, and your comments re the land grant also give me confidence that the ex Prisoner of War is our man. (My comments re land grant was based purely on the extract Todd had sent me which mentioned the men from the 60th who had fought in Europe. Good to know that other categories qualified as well.)

I'm looking forward to seeing the PoW registers tomorrow, fingers crossed!

Best regards
Ruth

[Quoted text hidden]

wdemelle . <wdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
Cc: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Mon, Aug 5, 2019 at 5:24 PM

My pleasure.

[Quoted text hidden]

Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
To: "wdemelle ." <wdemelle@gmail.com>
Cc: Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>

Mon, Aug 5, 2019 at 10:19 PM

This is quite a bit of a stretch, but for what it's worth, I remember my grandfather, Walter's father, Walter DeMelle Sr mentioning he thought Levi may have been from Holland and that he had fought in the Boer War. I have since thought that info must have been misremembered, Dutch probably gleaned from Deutsche, but now knowing Levi enlisted as a prisoner of war, who knows what might have brought him to his incarceration so I mention it here as an outside possibility.

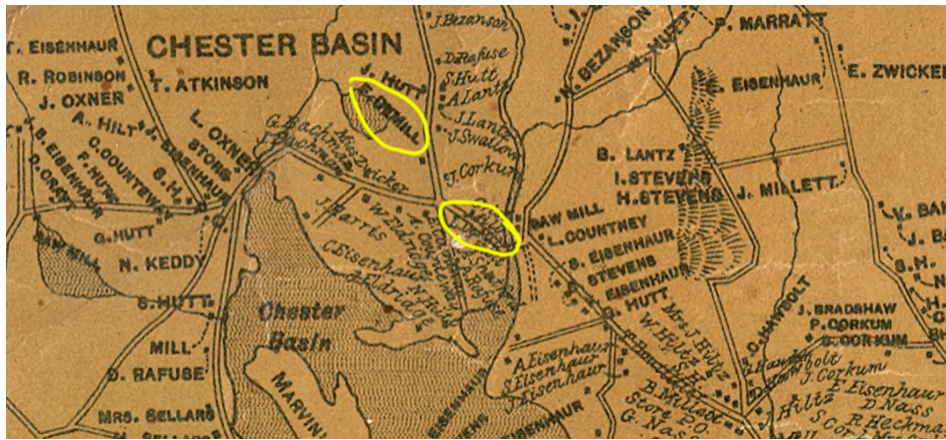
There is also this from Allen Robertson's research...

RG 20 "A": Post-1800 [Land Grant Papers]: DeMill, Levi ---see: Ross, William (Lieut.) & Others 1822

---Ross, William (Lieut.) & Others 1822: Draft Grant: to military settlers at Sherbrooke Settlement, 6900 acres of land in Lunenburg and Kings Counties. [Includes several German names: ... eg. Kiens, Graff, Clotiz, Shipain, Hession]: Levi DeMill-- 200 acres.

I also recently came across this map of Lunenburg County from 1864. <https://www.davidrumsey.com/luna/servlet/detail/RUMSEY~8~1~200267~3000165:Lunenburg-County-Nova-Scotia->

Here's a detail showing what I believe must be Levi's and Francis's residences where 'DeMill Rd.' continues to reside to this day!



I think the family lore is this plot of land was traded for, so that Levi being a fisherman, could be by the coast, and is not the original land grant. Fisherman suggests perhaps a comfort with seafaring? A clue?

The line from Levi to today is pretty well established in Canadian records.

Good hunting, Ruth!

Todd

[Quoted text hidden]

Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
To: "wdemelle ." <wdemelle@gmail.com>
Cc: Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>

Mon, Aug 5, 2019 at 10:53 PM

Just to note before someone else does, :) the first boer war was fought in 1880 which wouldn't work with Levi's timeline.

[Quoted text hidden]